GOLDENSPIRE GROUP · FREE PLAYBOOK

The After-Hours Playbook

How home-service businesses stop losing the calls that come in after 5 PM, starting with what you can fix this week for free.

- [ ] The 5-minute after-hours test
- [ ] Your missed-call math, in one worksheet
- [ ] The 5 leaks, and the free fix for each
- [ ] Copy-paste scripts: voicemail, review request, callback rule
- [ ] When to automate, and 5 questions to ask any vendor

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Written for subscribers. Please don't forward it around; send people to the signup page instead.

BEFORE YOU START

Why I wrote this

My day job is building AI systems for large companies. When I started helping businesses around here, I made two mistakes, and both taught me something.

First, I built things for free, as favors. They never got used. Not because the work was bad, but because nothing that costs nothing gets prioritized.

Second, I watched other people sell local owners shallow "AI": a chatbot bolted onto a website, set up once and never connected to how the business actually runs. It looked like progress for a month and then quietly stopped mattering.

What both taught me: the problem usually isn't technology. It's that nobody ever sat down and did the math on what's leaking out of the business when the office is closed. So that's what this playbook does. Most of it costs you nothing but an evening.

HOW TO USE IT

1. **Tonight:** run the after-hours test (page 3). Five minutes.
2. **Tomorrow:** fill in the missed-call worksheet (page 4) with your own numbers.
3. **This week:** make the free fixes (pages 5–6). No software required.
4. **Then decide:** if the math says it's worth automating, use page 7 to judge any vendor, including me.

> You don't need to buy anything to get value from this. If all you do is fix your voicemail greeting and start asking for reviews, it was worth the read.

STEP 1 · TONIGHT, 5 MINUTES

The after-hours test

Some evening after 6 PM, call your own business line from a phone the office doesn't recognize, the way a customer with no heat would. Then do it once on a Saturday morning. Check off what actually happens:

- [ ] Someone answers live
- [ ] It rings 6+ times before anything happens
- [ ] It goes to voicemail, and the greeting tells me what to do in an emergency
- [ ] It goes to voicemail with a generic greeting (or the mailbox is full)
- [ ] I get a text back within a few minutes
- [ ] Someone calls me back within 15 minutes
- [ ] Nobody gets back to me until the next business day

Then search for your business like a customer would

- [ ] Google shows the same phone number as my truck and website
- [ ] Google, Yelp, Facebook and Angi all show the same hours
- [ ] My hours are correct (not "Open 24 hours" by default when we aren't)
- [ ] I have a website, and it has a way to request service without calling
- [ ] My newest Google review is less than a month old

WHAT IT MEANS

Every unchecked box is a place a customer can give up and call the next company. Most shops I look at have three or more. Pick the worst one, then go to the worksheet.

STEP 2 · TOMORROW, 10 MINUTES

Your missed-call math

Use your own numbers. If you don't know one, guess low. The point is to see the size of the problem, not to scare yourself.

Question	Your number
A. Calls a week that go unanswered or to voicemail (evenings, weekends, while you're on a job)	_____
B. Of those, the share who'd have booked if someone answered right away (a third is a reasonable starting guess)	_____ %
C. Your average ticket for a service call	$ _____
Weekly leak = A × B × C	$ _____
Yearly leak = weekly × 52	$ _____

WORKED EXAMPLE (MADE-UP NUMBERS, NOT A REAL SHOP)

4 missed calls a week × 1 in 3 would book × $300 average ticket ≈ **$400 a week**, or about **$20,000 a year**. That's before counting the occasional caller who needed a full system replacement.

Two things this leaves out on purpose

Replacements and installs (one booked install can outweigh months of service calls), and lifetime value: a customer you win on a cold night tends to call you again. If your yearly number already looks worth fixing, those only make it bigger.

> Write your yearly number here: $ _____. That's the ceiling on what fixing this is worth to you. Anyone who wants to charge you more than a fraction of it isn't a good deal.

STEP 3 · THE LEAKS

The 5 leaks, and the free fix for each

1 **The dead-end voicemail.** The caller hears a generic greeting and no next step, so they hang up and call the next listing. *Free fix:* the voicemail script on page 6.

2 **The slow callback.** You call back the next morning, and they've already booked someone. *Free fix:* a callback rule. During business hours, every missed call gets a return call or text within 15 minutes, even if it's just "On a job, will call you by 4."

3 **Listings that disagree.** Different phone numbers or hours on Google, Yelp, Facebook and old directories. Some callers reach a dead line, others call at 9 PM because a listing says "Open 24 hours." *Free fix:* claim every listing and make the number and hours match exactly. Delete or correct old numbers.

4 **Reviews nobody asked for.** Unhappy customers post on their own and happy ones don't, so your rating drifts below the work you actually do. *Free fix:* the review-request text on page 6, sent the same day as every finished job.

5 **No way in without a phone call.** Plenty of people would rather text or fill out a form at 10 PM than call. *Free fix:* turn on messaging in your Google Business Profile, and put a short "Request service" form on your website that emails you.

ORDER OF OPERATIONS

Fix 3 first (it's an hour of work and it's pure loss), then 1 and 4 (scripts on page 6), then 2. Only consider paying for software for whatever is still leaking after that.

STEP 3 · COPY AND PASTE

Scripts you can use today

Voicemail greeting (record it in your own voice)

> "You've reached [Company]. We're out on jobs or closed right now. If you have no heat, no cooling, or water leaking, text the word URGENT to this number and we'll get right back to you. Otherwise, leave your name, address, and what's going on, and we'll call you back by [time] tomorrow. Thanks for calling [Company]."

Only promise a callback time you will actually keep. If you can't watch texts at night, drop the URGENT line and give the next-morning callback time instead.

Review request (text it the same day as the job)

> "Hi [Name], it's [Your name] from [Company]. Thanks for having us out today. If we did a good job, would you mind leaving a quick Google review? It really helps a small local business. [link] If anything wasn't right, just reply here and I'll make it right."

Ask everyone, not only the customers you expect to be happy. Asking selectively can break review sites' rules, and it doesn't help you learn anything.

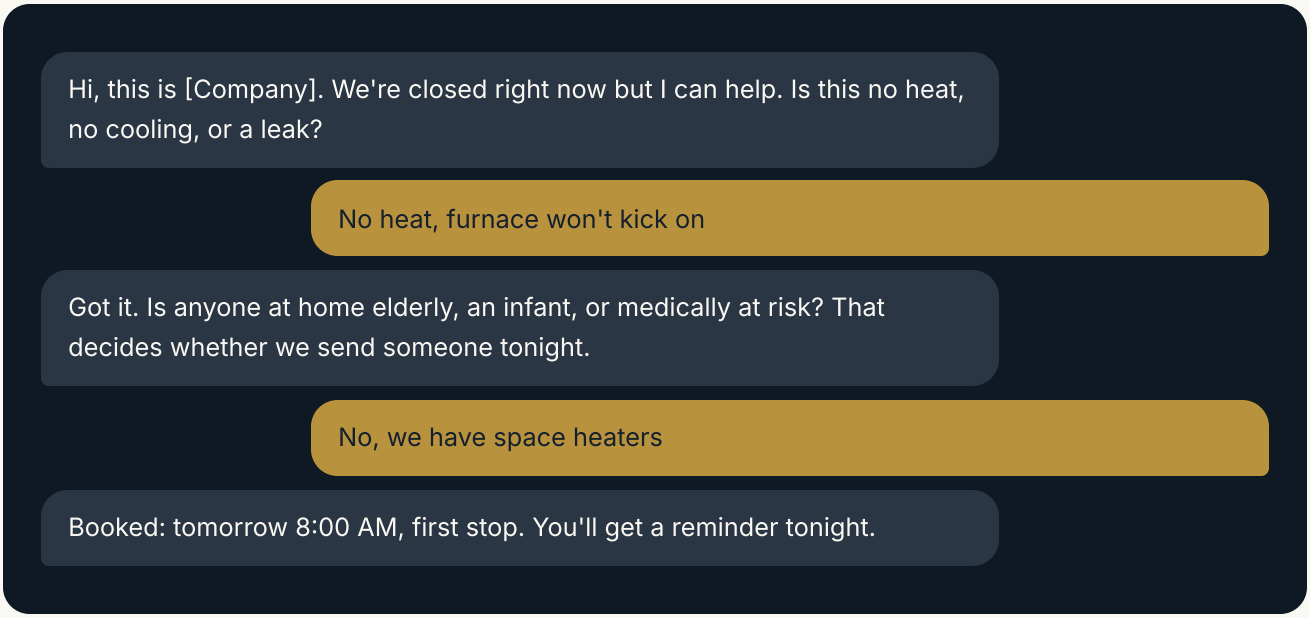
Missed-call text (send by hand during business hours)

> "Hi, this is [Name] at [Company]. Sorry I missed your call, I'm on a job. What's going on with your system? I'll call you back by [time]."

STEP 4 · ONLY IF THE MATH SAYS SO

When to automate, and what good looks like

If you've made the free fixes and your yearly number is still big, the next step is a system that does the missed-call text and booking for you, at night and on weekends. Done right, it looks something like this:



5 questions to ask any vendor (including me)

1. **Does it actually book jobs into my schedule,** or just take a message?
2. **Can I see and approve everything it says** to customers before it goes live?
3. **Do I own the accounts and phone number?** If I leave, does it all stay with me?
4. **What exactly must it do, in writing,** and what happens if it doesn't?
5. **What does it cost per year,** compared with my yearly leak number on page 4?

IF YOU WANT HELP

Fifteen minutes, your numbers, no pitch.

Send me your answers from pages 3 and 4. I'll tell you honestly whether automating is worth it for your shop, or whether the free fixes are enough.

My guarantee: before I build anything, we agree in writing on what it has to do. If it doesn't do that within the first 30 days, you don't pay for it.

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